

1. How It Started?

Ritesh Agarwal founded Oravel Stays in India in 2012, rebranding it as OYO Rooms in 2013. His entrepreneurial journey accelerated when he became the Asian recipient of the Thiel Fellowship in 2013, receiving a \$100,000 grant. A significant breakthrough for OYO occurred when a hotel in Gurgaon's HUDA City Center re-branded under OYO's management, leading to an increase in occupancy rates from 19% to 90% in the initial months. This success highlighted the potential of OYO's model, prompting Agarwal to focus on expanding affordable, standardized accommodations on a global scale.

Launch of OYO Rooms

Ritesh Agarwal founded OYO Rooms, aiming to standardize budget accommodations in India.

2013

Thiel Fellowship Awarded: Agarwal received the Thiel Fellowship, a \$100,000 grant supporting young entrepreneurs, providing crucial early-stage funding.



2018

Unicorn Status and Global Expansion

Achieved Unicorn Status: OYO raised \$1 billion in funding, achieving a valuation exceeding \$1 billion and marking its entry into the unicorn club.

Expansion into China: OYO expanded into China, rapidly becoming one of the country's largest hotel chains, showcasing its global ambitions.